SMRITI GANAPATHI

sganapathi@uchicago.edu Chicago, Illinois https://smriti-ganapathi.github.io/

EDUCATION

PhD. in Public Policy

Harris School of Public Policy, University of Chicago

2027 Chicago, USA

PhD scholarship by The Pearson Institute

- *Dissertation - "Enforcement, Norms, Framing: How Institutional Decisions Shape Gender-Based Violence"*

MSc. Economics and Social Sciences

Bocconi University

2018 Milan, Italy

Admitted with a merit scholarship.

- *Dissertation - "Tackling violence against women: can laws change perceptions?"*

GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

- 2026; 2023: $16,000, Development Economics Research Fund, University of Chicago & NHH – "Sexual Violence in South Africa".
- 2026: Center for Gender & Sexuality Studies Grant
- 2021: PhD scholarship by the Pearson Institute.
- 2021: $3000, Research funds by the Pearson Institute.
- 2015: Merit scholarship for Master's degree by Bocconi University.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

- *The Impact of Victim-Centric Institutions on the Perpetration of Sex Offenses* – with Daniela Horta-Saenz & Mazeeda Karani
- *Policing Intimate Partner Violence: Curbing Abuse or Shifting It?*
- *The Impact of Social Movements on Rape Rhetoric: Evidence from India*

POLICY WRITING

- Oeindrila Dube, Smriti Ganapathi, Soeren J. Henn, and James A. Robinson. 2020. "Farmer-Herder Conflict in Nigeria's Middle Belt: Evidence from 288 Communities." *Policy Report*.

CONFERENCES

Violence Prevention Research Conference

July 12-14, 2026 Porthsmouth NH, USA

International Society for the Prevention of Child Abuse and Neglect (ISPCAN) Congress

Oct 06-09, 2025 Vilnius, Lithuania

European Conference on multi-agency response to gender-based violence

May 16-17, 2019 Vilnius, Lithuania

Second International Symposium on Gender, Law and Constitutions

Apr 12-13, 2017 Washington DC, USA

SOFTWARE SKILLS

R Stata Python LaTex NVivo

LANGUAGES

English
Hindi & Tamil
Italian & French
Arabic & Hawaiian

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor - Program Evaluation

University of Chicago

Oct 2023 Chicago, U.S.A

Designed and taught course for international policy students students & practitioners.

Guest Lecturer: Violence in Schools

University of Chicago

Feb 2026 Chicago, U.S.A

Teaching Assistant

University of Chicago

Oct 2022 – Mar 2026 Chicago, U.S.A

Leading TA sessions & Office hours:

- Statistics for Data Analysis; Program Evaluation; Advanced Microeconomics

Supervising student research proposals:

- Education & Economic Development

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Research Assistant

University of Chicago

Jun 2022 – Oct 2022 Chicago, U.S.A

Projects related to domestic abuse, using causal machine learning.

Pre-doctoral Research Assistant

University of Chicago

Jul 2019 – Jul 2021 Chicago, U.S.A

Quasi-experimental projects & RCTs around conflict and gender.

Field Research Associate

Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL)

Jun 2018 – Dec 2018 Chennai, India

RCT on women's and children's health, overseeing primary data collection from over 10,000 households in 223 villages

MULTILATERAL ORGANIZATIONS

Evaluation Intern

International Fund for Agricultural Development

Mar 2019 – Jul 2019 Rome, Italy

Synthesized findings from 30 projects on community-driven development (CDD).

Intern- Crime Statistics

UN Office on Drugs and Crime

Jan 2018 – Apr 2018 Vienna, Austria

Compiled global data on violence against women, and contributed to the "Global Study on Homicide" report.